



Aeria Policy Document

1. Document Control / Header Information

Title

CRM - Situational Awareness Policy

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CRM1015

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Prepared By

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Approved By

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Amendment / Revision History

Date	Description of Change	Approved By
Sep 16, 2025	Initial release of the new document style	Dustin Wales
Date	[Description of change]	Person
Date	[Description of change]	Person

2. Purpose & Scope

Purpose

To establish a structured policy for building, maintaining, and recovering situational awareness (SA) in RPAS operations. Maintaining SA ensures operators perceive, comprehend, and anticipate operational conditions to minimize threats, prevent errors, and ensure mission safety.

Scope

Applies to all Aeria RPAS operational personnel, including Pilots in Command (PICs), Visual Observers (VOs), Operations Managers, subcontractors, and any supporting crew members involved in mission planning, execution, and debrief.

3. Definitions & References

Definitions

- Situational Awareness (SA): The perception of environmental elements, comprehension of their meaning, and projection of their future status.
- Levels of SA: Perception (recognizing factors), Comprehension (understanding meaning), Projection (anticipating outcomes).



- SA Loss: A condition where an operator becomes disconnected from mission-critical factors, leading to degraded safety.

References

- Aeria CRM Manual, Section: Situational Awareness
- Aeria RPAS Operations Manual, Section: Communication Techniques
- Transport Canada Advisory Circular 700-042, Appendix A

4. Policy Statement

Aeria Solutions requires all operators to actively build and sustain situational awareness throughout all phases of RPAS missions. Operators must use structured countermeasures, communication protocols, and workload distribution techniques to anticipate threats, recognize early signs of SA loss, and recover awareness immediately.

5. Procedures

Step-by-Step Actions

Pre-Mission (Build SA):

- Conduct thorough site surveys, environmental assessments, and risk reviews.
- Establish baseline awareness of airspace, weather, and equipment status.

During Mission (Maintain SA):

- Monitor telemetry, airspace, and environmental factors continuously.
- Apply three levels of SA (Perception → Comprehension → Projection).
- Use VO updates and communication protocols to maintain shared awareness.

SA Challenges:

- Recognize stress, distraction, or automation over-reliance as threats to SA.
- Conduct regular crew check-ins to confirm shared mental models.

Recovery from SA Loss:

- Pause non-critical tasks.
- Seek VO feedback or repeat system status checks
- Reassess mission priorities and restore shared SA before continuing.

Post-Mission (Debrief):

- Review SA strengths and weaknesses during team debrief.
- Document lapses, recovery methods, and lessons learned for future training.



Roles & Responsibilities for Each Step

- PIC: Maintain primary SA of mission and RPAS systems, escalate if awareness is compromised.
- VO: Monitor external environment, provide real-time updates, and alert PIC to threats.
- Operations Manager: Validate pre-mission environmental and risk assessments.
- Crew Members: Report distractions, fatigue, or SA lapses immediately.

Tools, Forms, or Checklists to be Used

- SA Pre-Mission Checklist (weather, airspace, risk review)
- VO Communication Update Log
- SA Recovery SOP

Safety/Compliance/Quality Requirements

- Compliance with CARs Part IX regarding continuous RPAS monitoring.
- Adherence to Aeria SOPs for crew briefings and communication updates.

Reporting or Escalation Processes

- All instances of SA loss or recovery must be documented in debrief reports.
- Escalation via P.A.C.E. protocol when SA loss poses safety risk.

6. Roles & Responsibilities

Management

- Ensure SA protocols are integrated into training and field audits.
- Review SA-related debrief findings during safety meetings.

Supervisors

- Confirm SA planning (weather, airspace, hazards) is completed before each mission.
- Lead post-mission reviews to capture SA lessons learned.



Staff

- Apply SA techniques at all times.
- Report barriers to maintaining SA (e.g., fatigue, distraction).

7. Monitoring, Compliance & Enforcement

How Compliance Will Be Monitored

- Field audits of SA performance during operations.
- Review of mission debriefs for documented SA lapses.
- Annual SA refresher training.

Consequences for Non-Compliance

- Corrective coaching or retraining for lapses.
- Disciplinary action for negligence resulting in safety compromise.

Reporting Obligations

- SA-related events must be logged in mission reports.
- Critical SA losses reported to the Accountable Executive.

8. Sign-Off & Acknowledgment

Approval Sign-Off

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Author	Dustin Wales		Sep 16, 2025
Reviewer	Person		Date



Role	Name	Signature	Date
Approver	Person		Date

Employee Acknowledgment Section

I, Person , acknowledge that I have read, understood, and agree to abide by the terms and conditions outlined in this Policy & Procedure document.

Date: Date